

# Cecilia Y. Sui

Seigle Hall 278, Department of Political Science,  
1 Brookings Drive, St. Louis, MO 63130

c.sui@wustl.edu  
ceciliaysui.com

## EDUCATION

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### Washington University in St. Louis, St. Louis, MO

Ph.D., Political Science, expected May 2027

M.A., Political Science, 2025

Committee: Jacob Montgomery (co-chair), Christopher Lucas (co-chair), Ted Enamorado, and Taylor Carlson

Subfields: Political Methodology (Major), American Politics (Minor)

### Lipscomb University, Nashville, TN

B.S., in Computer Science (minor in Political Science), 2020

## WORKING PAPERS

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**Cecilia Y. Sui.** “High Accuracy with Low Costs: The Pretrain-Finetune Paradigm for Classification with Transformer-Based Language Models” (*Conditionally Accepted at PSRM*)

**Cecilia Y. Sui,** Soyeon Jeon, Christopher Lucas, Jacob Montgomery, and Margit Tavits. “One Language is Enough: Using Transfer Learning to Detect Populist Rhetoric Across 25 Languages Without Translation” (NSF#2215008 and Carnegie#G-23-60440) (Under Review)

## WORK IN PROGRESS

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**Cecilia Y. Sui.** “Looking Close Without Feeling Close: A Generative AI Experiment on Influencer Style Political Communication”

**Cecilia Y. Sui.** “Seeing Inside the Black Box: Feature Attribution for Political Text in the Age of Language Models”

## GRANTS & AWARDS

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2026 WashU Weidenbaum Center Research Grant on Non-Textual Political Communication with Prof. Jacob Montgomery and Christopher Lucas (\$9,365)

WashU Political Science Department Travel Grant (\$500)

2025 WashU Dissertation Research Grant (\$1000)

WashU Political Science Department Travel Grant (\$900)

Google Cloud Research Grant (\$1000)

2023 WashU Antoinette Dames Prize for Best Graduate Level Paper (\$3000)

WashU Political Science Department LSQ Research Grant (\$5000)

WashU Political Science Department Travel Grant (\$900)

PolMeth NSF Summer Travel Grant (\$900)

MPSA Travel Grant (\$500)

## INVITED TALK

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2023 Peking University (PKU Analytics Lab for Global Risk Politics)

## CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

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2026 MPSA (paper)  
2025 PolMeth Annual Summer Meeting (paper)  
APSA (paper)  
2023 MPSA (paper)  
PolMeth Annual Summer Meeting (poster)

## SERVICE

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2024 Moderator of PolMeth ListServ  
2023 Moderator of PolMeth ListServ  
Department Graduate Student Mentor

## TEACHING

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Independent Instructor:  
Introduction to Python (Graduate), Summer 2023  
Introduction to R Programming (Graduate), Winter 2022

Assistant Instructor:  
Quantitative Political Methodology (Undergraduate, Ted Enamorado), Spring 2023  
Quantitative Political Methodology II (Graduate, Jacob Montgomery), Fall 2022  
Introduction to Python (Graduate, Annamaria Prati), Summer 2022  
Quantitative Political Methodology I (Graduate, Ted Enamorado), Spring 2022  
Mathematical Modeling (Graduate, Ted Enamorado), Fall 2021

## SKILLS

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Language: Mandarin-Chinese, English  
Programming: R, Python, HTML/CSS, Java, C, SQL, LATEX  
API and Tools: Twitter, TikTok, Meta Content Library, OpenAI, Claude Code, Azure, Amazon Mechanical Turk, HuggingFace, Upwork, Qualtrics, Prolific